

SPIRAL RAISES — WOLPERT

Opener may raise responder's major to 2M on 3- OR 4-card support.

Responder then asks with the cheapest step, and opener spirals out support length, strength, and shortness.

(Wolpert: Spiral Raises.)

After 1♦ 1♥ 2♥, responder asks with 2♠. Opener answers:

- 2N 3-card support, balanced, minimum
- 3♣ 4-card support, balanced
- 3♦ 3-card support, short in the other minor (♣)
- 3♥ 3-card support, short in the other major (♠)
- 3♠ 4-card support, splinter in ♠
- 3N 3-card support, balanced, maximum
- 4♣ 4-card support, splinter in the other minor (♣)
- 4♦ 5-4-2-2, maximum
- 4♥ 5-4-2-2, minimum

(5-4-2-2 means five in the opened minor with four-card support.)

After 1m 1♠ 2♠ the ask is 2N, the same scheme shifted up a step.

A 1♣ opening mirrors 1♦ with the minors swapped.

<https://bridgewinners.com/article/view/spiral-raises/>

4NT is Roman Keycard Blackwood (1430) with a trump suit agreed, or quantitative (inviting 6NT) in a notrump auction.

Keycard responses:

- 5♣ = 1 or 4 keycards
- 5♦ = 0 or 3
- 5♥ = 2 without the trump queen
- 5♠ = 2 with the trump queen